Until the release of HTML 5, there were very few alternatives to cookies for storing tokens in a web browser client. Now there are two widely-supported alternatives:

- The Web Storage API that includes the `localStorage` and `sessionStorage` objects for storing simple key-value pairs.
- The IndexedDB API that allows storing larger amounts of data in a more sophisticated JSON NoSQL database.

Both APIs provide significantly greater storage capacity than cookies, which are typically limited to just 4KB of storage for all cookies for a single domain. However, as session tokens are relatively small, you can stick to the simpler Web Storage API in this chapter. While IndexedDB has even larger storage limits than Web Storage, it typically requires explicit user consent before it can be used. By replacing cookies for storage on the client, you will now have a replacement for all three aspects of token-based authentication provided by cookies, as shown in figure 5.4:

- On the backend, you can manually store cookie state in a database to replace the cookie storage provided by most web frameworks.
- You can use the Bearer authentication scheme as a standard way to communicate tokens from the client to the API, and to prompt for tokens when not supplied.
- Cookies can be replaced on the client by the Web Storage API.